

FILE : T07_AI_Trucking_2026-10-01_1649.md
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PURPOSE : Teacher lesson plan for "AI for Trucking and Logistics" (industry track).
READ FIRST: 00_IEBC_Teaching_Playbook_2026-10-01_1649.md
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T07 Teacher Guide: AI for Trucking and Logistics

Format	Self-paced video + live Q&A (twice a month for this track)
Length	6 modules, about 6 hours of student time (about 90 minutes of video)
Level	Intermediate
Demo business	Summit Freight Co. (8 trucks, 2 office staff)
Case study	3 Lakes Logistics, using only what's published on the IEBC website
Student deliverable	Driver onboarding workflow, document checklist and settlement process

Who should teach this

Teachers need hands-on trucking back-office experience (dispatch, driver files, settlements, IFTA). If you don't have it, co-teach with someone who does. Students in this industry quickly tune out teachers who don't know what a rate con or a POD is.

★ **Compliance rule:** AI helps organize and remind; it does not decide compliance. FMCSA/DOT rules, HOS and drug-and-alcohol requirements come from the regulations and the carrier's safety professional. Say this in Module 1 and Module 4.

Course-level objectives

Students can identify back-office time sinks, organize loads and documents, digitize driver onboarding, automate expiry reminders, run weekly settlements with fewer errors, and design an AI agent with human sign-off.

Module 1: Where AI fits in a trucking operation (2 videos, ~12 min)

★ MUST TEACH:

1. The back-office map: load intake → dispatch → driver docs → billing/factoring → settlements → IFTA.
2. Time audit for carriers (T02 method with trucking examples: chasing PODs, re-keying rate cons, settlement math).
3. What small fleets can use today without enterprise software.
4. The compliance rule above.

SHOW: Summit Freight's time audit: top 3 = POD chasing, settlement prep, driver file expirations.

BUILD: Students do their own audit.

Module 2: Dispatch and load tracking (3 videos, ~18 min)

★ MUST TEACH:

1. One load record with every document attached (rate con, BOL, POD, lumper receipts).
2. AI extraction: rate con PDF → load record fields (broker, pickup, delivery, rate, reference numbers).
3. ★ Mistake moment: AI swaps pickup and delivery dates or misreads the rate. **Always verify rate and dates against the PDF.**
4. Revenue per mile and per lane: the one report that changes decisions.

SHOW: 5 Summit rate cons extracted, one error caught; a revenue-per-mile table. **TRY:** Students extract the 5 demo rate cons and compare to the answer key.

Module 3: Driver onboarding and documents (3 videos, ~18 min)

★ MUST TEACH:

1. Digital application + e-signature for agreements.
2. Driver file checklist (application, MVR, medical card, CDL copy, road test or equivalent, drug test records); ★ say the safety professional confirms the required list.
3. Document vault naming convention: `DriverLast_DocType_YYYY-MM-DD`.
4. Collect documents by upload link, not text messages.

SHOW: Summit's onboarding flow from application to "ready to dispatch." **Assignment 1:** Digital driver onboarding checklist + application flow.

Not yet	Meets	Strong
Paper-based or missing key docs	Digital flow with all checklist items and e-sign	Also automatic reminders for missing items

Module 4: Safety and compliance support (2 videos, ~12 min)

★ **MUST TEACH:** expiry reminders (medical card, CDL, registration, insurance) at 60/30/7 days; AI to flag missing paperwork in a driver file; the compliance rule again.

Module 5: Settlements and back office (3 videos, ~18 min)

★ **MUST TEACH:**

1. Weekly settlement: loads, pay basis (percentage or per mile), deductions, advances, escrow.
2. A settlement template that pulls from load records instead of re-typing.
3. ★ Two-person check before paying drivers; AI may prepare, a person approves.
4. IFTA: miles and fuel by state, kept weekly, not at quarter-end.
5. Factoring paperwork: what to send and how to keep it organized.

SHOW: Summit's weekly settlement for 3 drivers, with one deduction error caught in the check.

Module 6: AI agents for fleets (2 videos, ~12 min)

★ **MUST TEACH:**

1. What an agent is (T01 definition) and when it beats a simple automation.
2. Agent job description: goal, inputs, allowed actions, rules, when to ask a human.
3. Case study: 3 Lakes Logistics uses AI agents for onboarding, safety (Shield) and settlements (Settler), with people approving. Describe only what's on the IEBC website.

Assignment 2 (final): Settlement process document + an agent job description for one back-office process.

Not yet	Meets	Strong
No approval step or vague agent job	Settlement steps with two-person check; agent job has inputs, rules, human sign-off	Also a test plan for the agent

Live Q&A focus

Students bring real (redacted) rate cons and settlement problems. Never put real driver personal data on screen; ask for redacted copies.